🤖 STOP GENERATING TEST SLOP

Cursor Rules for Deterministic Playwright

Ask an AI assistant to write E2E tests and you can ship 50 specs in an afternoon, then spend six months debugging CI flakes.

AI isn't bad at writing tests. It's bad at guessing your architectural standards.

📜 **The Fix**

Pin Cursor and Claude to a strict `.cursor/rules/*.mdc` contract so deterministic patterns are the only code they emit.

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Swipe ➔

Why LLMs Default to 2018 Selenium Habits

Public training data is full of legacy scripts. Without guardrails, AI assistants reproduce three classic anti-patterns:

🎯 **1. Brittle CSS & XPath Chains**

Deep DOM paths (`div.container > div:nth-child(2)`) break the moment a designer adjusts Tailwind classes.

⏱️ **2. Arbitrary `waitForTimeout()` Sleeps**

Hardcoded 5-second waits inflate CI runtime and still flake whenever backend latency spikes.

🍝 **3. Monolithic Test Scripts**

200-line procedural specs with zero Page Object encapsulation become unmaintainable within weeks.

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The Accessibility-First Locator Hierarchy

Force the AI to query the browser's Accessibility Tree in this exact priority order:

1. `page.getByRole('button', { name })` (First choice)
2. `page.getByLabel('Work Email')` (Form fields)
3. `page.getByPlaceholder(...)` (When no label exists)
4. `page.getByText('Success')` (Non-interactive text)
5. `page.getByTestId(...)` (Last resort only)

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Before vs. After
Pinning .cursor/rules/

❌ WITHOUT RULES (BRITTLE & SLOW)

```
await page.locator('#email_input_field').fill(email);
await page.click('.btn-primary-blue');
await page.waitForTimeout(4000);
expect(await page.locator('.title').innerText()).toBe('Home');
```

✅ WITH RULES (POM + AUTO-WAIT + A11Y)

```
await loginPage.login(email, password);
await expect(dashboardPage.heading).toBeVisible();
await loginPage.checkAccessibility();
```

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3 Guardrails to Put in .cursor/rules/ Today

- ✓ **Ban `waitForTimeout()` and XPath** explicitly in your rule file.
- ✓ **Enforce a strict POM boundary** so specs only call intent methods.
- ✓ **Require `@axe-core/playwright`** on every critical user flow.

Copy the Full Rule Template

Grab the ready-to-paste `.mdc` rule file from the link in the first comment below.

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